

GOOD GOVERNANCE: CONCEPTS AND FRAMEWORKS

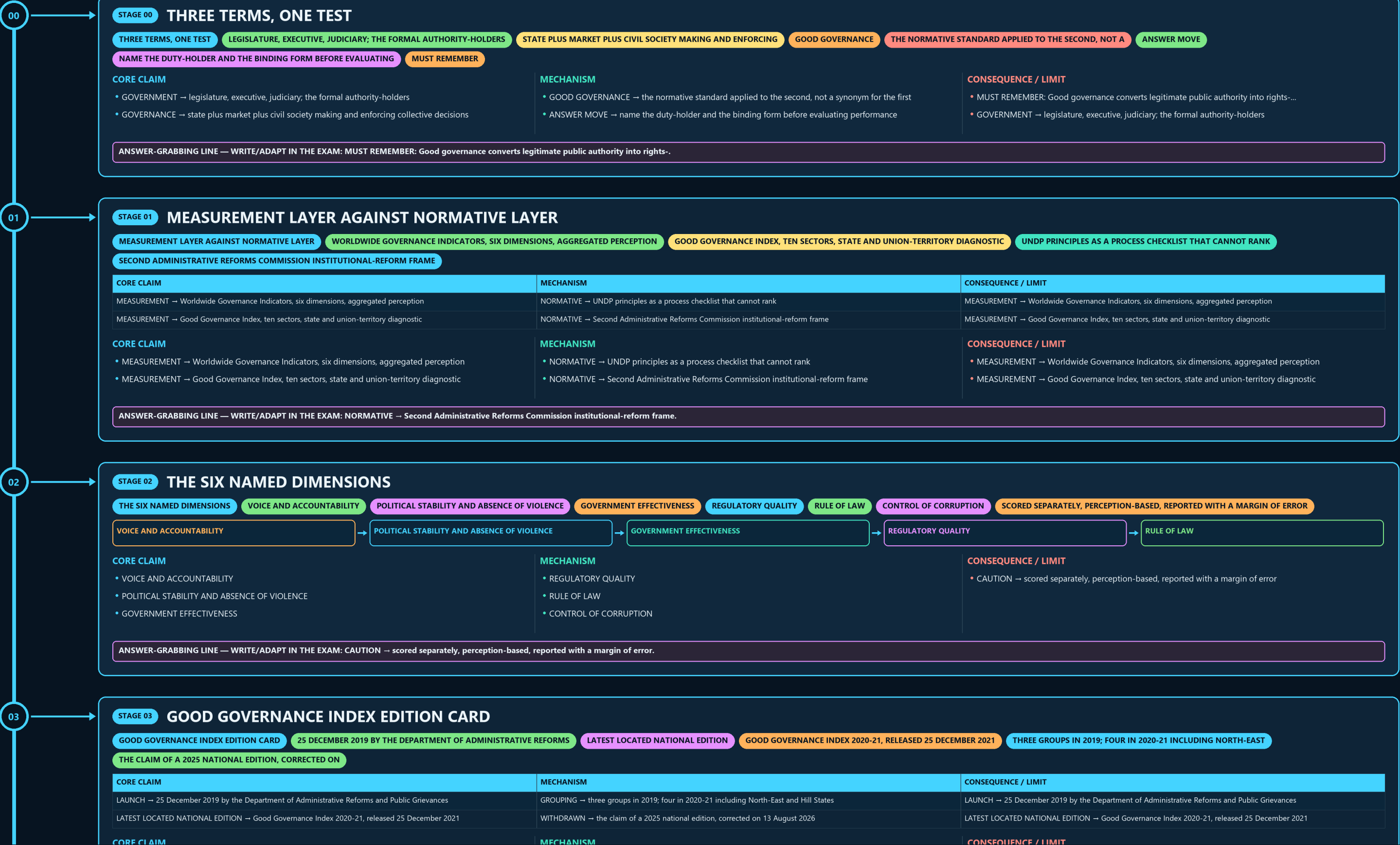
THREE TERMS, ONE TEST → MEASUREMENT LAYER AGAINST NORMATIVE → THE SIX NAMED DIMENSIONS → GOOD GOVERNANCE INDEX EDITION → WHAT MAY NOT BE → ATTRIBUTION DISCIPLINE

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g3 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles



ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CAUTION → scored separately, perception-based, reported with a margin of error.

03

STAGE 03 GOOD GOVERNANCE INDEX EDITION CARD

GOOD GOVERNANCE INDEX EDITION CARD

25 DECEMBER 2019 BY THE DEPARTMENT OF ADMINISTRATIVE REFORMS

LATEST LOCATED NATIONAL EDITION

GOOD GOVERNANCE INDEX 2020-21, RELEASED 25 DECEMBER 2021

THREE GROUPS IN 2019; FOUR IN 2020-21 INCLUDING NORTH-EAST

THE CLAIM OF A 2025 NATIONAL EDITION, CORRECTED ON

CORE CLAIM

LAUNCH → 25 December 2019 by the Department of Administrative Reforms and Public Grievances

LATEST LOCATED NATIONAL EDITION → Good Governance Index 2020-21, released 25 December 2021

MECHANISM

GROUPING → three groups in 2019; four in 2020-21 including North-East and Hill States

WITHDRAWN → the claim of a 2025 national edition, corrected on 13 August 2026

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

LAUNCH → 25 December 2019 by the Department of Administrative Reforms and Public Grievances

LATEST LOCATED NATIONAL EDITION → Good Governance Index 2020-21, released 25 December 2021

CORE CLAIM

• LAUNCH → 25 December 2019 by the Department of Administrative Reforms and Public Grievances

• LATEST LOCATED NATIONAL EDITION → Good Governance Index 2020-21, released 25 December 2021

MECHANISM

• GROUPING → three groups in 2019; four in 2020-21 including North-East and Hill States

• WITHDRAWN → the claim of a 2025 national edition, corrected on 13 August 2026

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

• LAUNCH → 25 December 2019 by the Department of Administrative Reforms and Public Grievances

• LATEST LOCATED NATIONAL EDITION → Good Governance Index 2020-21, released 25 December 2021

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: WITHDRAWN → the claim of a 2025 national edition, corrected on 13 August 2026.

04

STAGE 04 WHAT MAY NOT BE ASSERTED

WHAT MAY NOT BE ASSERTED

LAUNCH DATE, LOCATED EDITION, EDITION-SPECIFIC GROUPING, GOOD GOVERNANCE DAY

A RANK ONLY WITH ITS EDITION YEAR ATTACHED

ANY POST-2021 NATIONAL EDITION, RANK, SCORE, INDICATOR COUNT OR

THE DISTRICT GOOD GOVERNANCE INDEX TREATED AS A NATIONAL

SAFE → launch date, located edition, edition-specific grouping, Good Governance Day since 2014

BOUNDED → a rank only with its edition year attached

PROHIBITED → any post-2021 national edition, rank, score, indicator count or top performer

PROHIBITED → the District Good Governance Index treated as a national edition

CORE CLAIM

• SAFE → launch date, located edition, edition-specific grouping, Good Governance Day since 2014

• BOUNDED → a rank only with its edition year attached

MECHANISM

• PROHIBITED → any post-2021 national edition, rank, score, indicator count or top performer

• PROHIBITED → the District Good Governance Index treated as a national edition

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

• SAFE → launch date, located edition, edition-specific grouping, Good Governance Day since 2014

• BOUNDED → a rank only with its edition year attached

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: PROHIBITED → the District Good Governance Index treated as a national edition.

05

STAGE 05 ATTRIBUTION DISCIPLINE

ATTRIBUTION DISCIPLINE

WORLD BANK

WORLDWIDE GOVERNANCE INDICATORS, SIX DIMENSIONS, CROSS-COUNTRY

WORLD JUSTICE PROJECT

RULE OF LAW INDEX, PUBLISHED ANNUALLY, DISTINCT FAMILY

DEPARTMENT OF ADMINISTRATIVE REFORMS

GOOD GOVERNANCE INDEX AND GOOD GOVERNANCE DAY

MINISTRY OF PANCHAYATI RAJ

CORE CLAIM

WORLD BANK → Worldwide Governance Indicators, six dimensions, cross-country

WORLD JUSTICE PROJECT → Rule of Law Index, published annually, distinct family

MECHANISM

DEPARTMENT OF ADMINISTRATIVE REFORMS → Good Governance Index and Good Governance Day

MINISTRY OF PANCHAYATI RAJ → Devolution Index, panchayat scope only

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

WORLD BANK → Worldwide Governance Indicators, six dimensions, cross-country

WORLD JUSTICE PROJECT → Rule of Law Index, published annually, distinct family

CORE CLAIM

• WORLD BANK → Worldwide Governance Indicators, six dimensions, cross-country

• WORLD JUSTICE PROJECT → Rule of Law Index, published annually, distinct family

MECHANISM

• DEPARTMENT OF ADMINISTRATIVE REFORMS → Good Governance Index and Good Governance Day

• MINISTRY OF PANCHAYATI RAJ → Devolution Index, panchayat scope only

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

• WORLD BANK → Worldwide Governance Indicators, six dimensions, cross-country

• WORLD JUSTICE PROJECT → Rule of Law Index, published annually, distinct family

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: WORLD JUSTICE PROJECT → Rule of Law Index, published annually, distinct family.

06

STAGE 06 FOUR OBJECTS AT FOUR SCALES

FOUR OBJECTS AT FOUR SCALES

WORLDWIDE GOVERNANCE INDICATORS BENCHMARK OVER TIME

STATE SECTORAL

GOOD GOVERNANCE INDEX, TEN SECTORS, COMPARISON CATEGORIES

SERVICE PORTAL

NATIONAL E-GOVERNANCE SERVICE DELIVERY ASSESSMENT, END-SERVICE DEPTH

DEVOLUTION INDEX; URBAN LOCAL BODIES ARE OUTSIDE ITS SCOPE

CORE CLAIM

CROSS-COUNTRY → Worldwide Governance Indicators benchmark over time

STATE SECTORAL → Good Governance Index, ten sectors, comparison categories

MECHANISM

SERVICE PORTAL → National e-Governance Service Delivery Assessment, end-service depth

PANCHAYAT → Devolution Index; urban local bodies are outside its scope

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

CROSS-COUNTRY → Worldwide Governance Indicators benchmark over time

STATE SECTORAL → Good Governance Index, ten sectors, comparison categories

CORE CLAIM

• CROSS-COUNTRY → Worldwide Governance Indicators benchmark over time

MECHANISM

• SERVICE PORTAL → National e-Governance Service Delivery Assessment, end-service depth

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

• CROSS-COUNTRY → Worldwide Governance Indicators benchmark over time

06

STAGE 06

FOUR OBJECTS AT FOUR SCALES

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WORLDWIDE GOVERNANCE INDICATORS BENCHMARK OVER TIME

STATE SECTORAL

GOOD GOVERNANCE INDEX, TEN SECTORS, COMPARISON CATEGORIES

SERVICE PORTAL

NATIONAL E-GOVERNANCE SERVICE DELIVERY ASSESSMENT, END-SERVICE DEPTH

DEVOLUTION INDEX; URBAN LOCAL BODIES ARE OUTSIDE ITS SCOPE

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
CROSS-COUNTRY → Worldwide Governance Indicators benchmark over time	SERVICE PORTAL → National e-Governance Service Delivery Assessment, end-service depth	CROSS-COUNTRY → Worldwide Governance Indicators benchmark over time
STATE SECTORAL → Good Governance Index, ten sectors, comparison categories	PANCHAYAT → Devolution Index; urban local bodies are outside its scope	STATE SECTORAL → Good Governance Index, ten sectors, comparison categories

CORE CLAIM

CROSS-COUNTRY → Worldwide Governance Indicators benchmark over time

STATE SECTORAL → Good Governance Index, ten sectors, comparison categories

MECHANISM

SERVICE PORTAL → National e-Governance Service Delivery Assessment, end-service depth

PANCHAYAT → Devolution Index; urban local bodies are outside its scope

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

CROSS-COUNTRY → Worldwide Governance Indicators benchmark over time

STATE SECTORAL → Good Governance Index, ten sectors, comparison categories

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: PANCHAYAT → Devolution Index; urban local bodies are outside its scope.

07

STAGE 07

NORM TO INSTRUMENT, LEGALITY HALF

NORM TO INSTRUMENT, LEGALITY HALF

RULE OF LAW

ARTICLE 14 NON-ARBITRARINESS AND REASONED ORDERS; UNEVEN BELOW THE

RIGHT TO INFORMATION ACT, 2005, SECTION 4 PROACTIVE DISCLOSURE

COMPTROLLER AND AUDITOR GENERAL, ARTICLES 148 TO 151; AUDIT

LOKPAL ACT, 2013 AND CENTRAL VIGILANCE COMMISSION ACT, 2003

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
RULE OF LAW → Article 14 non-arbitrariness and reasoned orders; uneven below the regulator tier	ACCOUNTABILITY → Comptroller and Auditor General, Articles 148 to 151; audit remedy	RULE OF LAW → Article 14 non-arbitrariness and reasoned orders; uneven below the regulator tier
TRANSPARENCY → Right to Information Act, 2005, Section 4 proactive disclosure; unaudited compliance	ACCOUNTABILITY → Lokpal Act, 2013 and Central Vigilance Commission Act, 2003; distinct remedies	TRANSPARENCY → Right to Information Act, 2005, Section 4 proactive disclosure; unaudited compliance

CORE CLAIM

RULE OF LAW → Article 14 non-arbitrariness and reasoned orders; uneven below the regulator tier

TRANSPARENCY → Right to Information Act, 2005, Section 4 proactive disclosure; unaudited compliance

MECHANISM

ACCOUNTABILITY → Comptroller and Auditor General, Articles 148 to 151; audit remedy

ACCOUNTABILITY → Lokpal Act, 2013 and Central Vigilance Commission Act, 2003; distinct remedies

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

RULE OF LAW → Article 14 non-arbitrariness and reasoned orders; uneven below the regulator tier

TRANSPARENCY → Right to Information Act, 2005, Section 4 proactive disclosure; unaudited compliance

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE OF LAW → Article 14 non-arbitrariness and reasoned orders; uneven below the regulator tier.

08

STAGE 08

NORM TO INSTRUMENT, DELIVERY HALF

NORM TO INSTRUMENT, DELIVERY HALF

SECTION 17 GRAM SABHA SOCIAL AUDIT; PRE-LEGISLATIVE CONSULTATION POLICY

STATE RIGHT-TO-SERVICE ACTS FROM MADHYA PRADESH, 2010; NOTIFIED SERVICES

GRIEVANCE PORTAL TWENTY-ONE-DAY BENCHMARK, DEPARTMENTAL GUIDELINES AUGUST 2024

EQUITY AND EFFECTIVENESS

DIRECT BENEFIT TRANSFER TARGETING; OUTPUT-OUTCOME MONITORING FRAMEWORK

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
PARTICIPATION → Section 17 Gram Sabha social audit; Pre-Legislative Consultation Policy, 2014	RESPONSIVENESS → grievance portal twenty-one-day benchmark, departmental guidelines August 2024	PARTICIPATION → Section 17 Gram Sabha social audit; Pre-Legislative Consultation Policy, 2014
RESPONSIVENESS → state right-to-service Acts from Madhya Pradesh, 2010; notified services only	EQUITY AND EFFECTIVENESS → direct benefit transfer targeting; Output-Outcome Monitoring Framework	RESPONSIVENESS → state right-to-service Acts from Madhya Pradesh, 2010; notified services only

CORE CLAIM

PARTICIPATION → Section 17 Gram Sabha social audit; Pre-Legislative Consultation Policy, 2014

RESPONSIVENESS → state right-to-service Acts from Madhya Pradesh, 2010; notified services only

MECHANISM

RESPONSIVENESS → grievance portal twenty-one-day benchmark, departmental guidelines August 2024

EQUITY AND EFFECTIVENESS → direct benefit transfer targeting; Output-Outcome Monitoring Framework

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

PARTICIPATION → Section 17 Gram Sabha social audit; Pre-Legislative Consultation Policy, 2014

RESPONSIVENESS → state right-to-service Acts from Madhya Pradesh, 2010; notified services only

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: EQUITY AND EFFECTIVENESS → direct benefit transfer targeting; Output-Outcome Monitoring Framework.

09

STAGE 09

SEVEN STAGES FROM NORM TO OUTCOME

SEVEN STAGES FROM NORM TO OUTCOME

LEGAL FORM

ACT, RULE, GUIDELINE OR EXECUTIVE POLICY, AND WHO IS

INSTITUTION AND PROCEDURE

IDENTIFIED DUTY-HOLDER, TIMELINE, OFFICER, APPEAL, PENALTY

CAPACITY AND CITIZEN SIDE

STAFF, RECORDS, BUDGET; AWARENESS, DISTANCE, COST, LANGUAGE

REMEDY AND FEEDBACK

LEGAL FORM → Act, rule, guideline or executive policy, and who is bound

INSTITUTION AND PROCEDURE → identified duty-holder, timeline, officer, appeal, penalty

CAPACITY AND CITIZEN SIDE → staff, records, budget; awareness, distance, cost, language

REMEDY AND FEEDBACK → is failure correctable, and is it counted and used for redesign

CLOSE DISTINCTION: Government is the formal authority structure, governance is the wider

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
LEGAL FORM → Act, rule, guideline or executive policy, and who is bound	CAPACITY AND CITIZEN SIDE → staff, records, budget; awareness, distance, cost, language	CLOSE DISTINCTION: Government is the formal authority structure, governance is the wider...
INSTITUTION AND PROCEDURE → identified duty-holder, timeline, officer, appeal, penalty	REMEDY AND FEEDBACK → is failure correctable, and is it counted and used for redesign	LEGAL FORM → Act, rule, guideline or executive policy, and who is bound

09

STAGE 09 SEVEN STAGES FROM NORM TO OUTCOME

SEVEN STAGES FROM NORM TO OUTCOME

LEGAL FORM

ACT, RULE, GUIDELINE OR EXECUTIVE POLICY, AND WHO IS

INSTITUTION AND PROCEDURE

IDENTIFIED DUTY-HOLDER, TIMELINE, OFFICER, APPEAL, PENALTY

CAPACITY AND CITIZEN SIDE

STAFF, RECORDS, BUDGET; AWARENESS, DISTANCE, COST, LANGUAGE

REMEDY AND FEEDBACK

LEGAL FORM → Act, rule, guideline or executive policy, and who is bound

INSTITUTION AND PROCEDURE → identified duty-holder, timeline, officer, appeal, penalty

CAPACITY AND CITIZEN SIDE → staff, records, budget; awareness, distance, cost, language

REMEDY AND FEEDBACK → is failure correctable, and is it counted and used for redesign

CLOSE DISTINCTION: Government is the formal authority structure, governance is the wider

CORE CLAIM

- LEGAL FORM → Act, rule, guideline or executive policy, and who is bound
- INSTITUTION AND PROCEDURE → identified duty-holder, timeline, officer, appeal, penalty

MECHANISM

- CAPACITY AND CITIZEN SIDE → staff, records, budget; awareness, distance, cost, language
- REMEDY AND FEEDBACK → is failure correctable, and is it counted and used for redesign

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- CLOSE DISTINCTION: Government is the formal authority structure, governance is the wider...
- LEGAL FORM → Act, rule, guideline or executive policy, and who is bound

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LEGAL FORM → Act, rule, guideline or executive policy, and who is bound.

10

STAGE 10 FIVE INDEX TESTS

FIVE INDEX TESTS

INDICATOR VALIDITY

DOES IT MEASURE THE GOVERNED OUTCOME OR AN EASILY

IS THE DATA SELF-REPORTED BY THE ENTITY BEING RANKED

OUTPUT AGAINST OUTCOME

HOW MUCH OF THE SCORE IS COVERAGE RATHER THAN

ADJUSTMENT AND CONSEQUENCE

LIKE-FOR-LIKE FEDERAL COMPARISON; DOES A POOR SCORE TRIGGER CORRECTION

INDICATOR VALIDITY → does it measure the governed outcome or an easily counted input

COMPARABILITY → is the data self-reported by the entity being ranked

OUTPUT AGAINST OUTCOME → how much of the score is coverage rather than realised change

ADJUSTMENT AND CONSEQUENCE → like-for-like federal comparison; does a poor score trigger correction

AUTHORITY / EVIDENCE / IMPLEMENTATION LIMIT: Use constitutional values, citizen charters

CORE CLAIM

- INDICATOR VALIDITY → does it measure the governed outcome or an easily counted input
- COMPARABILITY → is the data self-reported by the entity being ranked

MECHANISM

- OUTPUT AGAINST OUTCOME → how much of the score is coverage rather than realised change
- ADJUSTMENT AND CONSEQUENCE → like-for-like federal comparison; does a poor score trigger correction

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- AUTHORITY / EVIDENCE / IMPLEMENTATION LIMIT: Use constitutional values, citizen charters,...
- INDICATOR VALIDITY → does it measure the governed outcome or an easily counted input

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: AUTHORITY / EVIDENCE / IMPLEMENTATION LIMIT: Use constitutional values, citizen charters,.

11

STAGE 11 ANSWER SPINE AND ANSWERED OBJECTIONS

ANSWER SPINE AND ANSWERED OBJECTIONS

SEPARATE THE INSTITUTION SET, THE DECISION PROCESS AND THE

NORM TO NAMED INSTRUMENT TO MECHANISM TO STATED LIMITATION

FIVE INDEX TESTS; ANSWER VAGUENESS, MEASUREMENT, CONDITIONALITY AND CAPACITY

GRADED VERDICT WITH THE EDITION-DATED EVIDENCE AND THE CONDITION

OPEN → separate the institution set, the decision process and the normative standard

BUILD → norm to named instrument to mechanism to stated limitation, three to six units

TEST → five index tests; answer vagueness, measurement, conditionality and capacity objections

CLOSE → graded verdict with the edition-dated evidence and the condition that would reverse it

CORE CLAIM

- OPEN → separate the institution set, the decision process and the normative standard
- BUILD → norm to named instrument to mechanism to stated limitation, three to six units

MECHANISM

- TEST → five index tests; answer vagueness, measurement, conditionality and capacity objections
- CLOSE → graded verdict with the edition-dated evidence and the condition that would reverse it

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- OPEN → separate the institution set, the decision process and the normative standard
- BUILD → norm to named instrument to mechanism to stated limitation, three to six units

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE → graded verdict with the edition-dated evidence and the condition that would reverse it.

E

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT

INDICATOR CAPTURE

ADMINISTRATIVE EFFORT SHIFTS TOWARD IMPROVING THE MEASURED PROXY

PERCEPTION-MEASUREMENT GAP

WGI'S PERCEPTION BASIS MEANS A STATE CAN IMPROVE

FEDERAL COMPARABILITY PROBLEM

GGI'S EDITION-SPECIFIC GROUPING

DARPG FUNCTIONS AS BOTH THE NODAL REFORM DEPARTMENT (ARC)

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH

- CAUTION: Indicator capture: administrative effort shifts toward improving the measured proxy
- CAUTION: Perception-measurement gap: WGI's perception basis means a state can improve
- CAUTION: Federal comparability problem: GGI's edition-specific grouping
- DARPG functions as both the nodal reform department (ARC follow-up, Sevottam,

ADVANCED DEBATE

- 2nd ARC's 15 reports operationalise the normative "good governance" standard into
- CAUTION: The absence of a single statutory "Good Governance Act" in India means the standard is
- CAUTION: A state can score well on GGI's "economic governance" sector through ease-of-business
- CAUTION: Comparing WGI's "Government Effectiveness" dimension with India's own e-governance/DPI

LEGACY / NUANCE

- CAUTION: Boundary case: an authoritarian-leaning but highly efficient administrative unit could
- CAUTION: Composite indices trade descriptive richness for comparability; over-reliance on GGI
- CAUTION: Normative frameworks (UNDP, ARC) resist gaming but offer no ready metric for tracking
- CAUTION: India's federal structure means Union-level frameworks (GGI, DARPG reform) can diagnose

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.